J01 / JOURNAL PREPARATION

Prepare the source record

Bookkeeping / Journal / Post Transaction

Use one journal for one economic event. Gather the evidence before choosing accounts.

01 **Identify the event**

Record the payee or payer, what changed, the business purpose and who approved it. Keep the invoice, receipt, BCEL advice, POS close or signed cash slip with its reference.

02 **Set the dates**

The main date places the journal in the accounting month. Keep individual receipt dates on the lines. For receipts from another month, review the warning and preserve the original date in the memo. Select the correct open period before posting.

03 **Enter each leg**

Select an active posting account, fund or employee where required. The account determines the currency. Enter the amount in either Debit or Credit, with the original quantity and supported rate for foreign currency.

04 **Write a usable description**

Give the shared purpose once. Use line memos for items, receipt dates, quantities, rates or references that differ. Link the evidence so someone else can reconstruct the entry.

Example memo

Kitchen supplies for the restaurant, paid from petty cash. Line memo: vegetables, receipt A17, 6 November.

Before you finish

Check the source against the date, currency, funding account and total. Search Active Journal and Submitted for an existing entry with the same evidence.